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Halloween: From Ancient Tradition to Modern Celebration

On October 31st, many countries celebrate Halloween. Children dress up in costumes, carve pumpkins into jack-o'-lanterns, and go door to door saying "trick or treat" to collect candy. What began as an ancient festival has grown into a fun, creative holiday enjoyed by people of all ages. [1] Halloween has a long and fascinating history, and understanding where it came from helps us appreciate how traditions change and spread across cultures over time.

The holiday has roots in an ancient Celtic festival called Samhain. The Celts believed that on the night of October 31st, the boundary between the living and the dead became thin, and spirits could cross over. People lit bonfires and wore disguises to ward off evil spirits. When Christianity spread, the church combined this tradition with All Saints' Day on November 1st, and the night before became known as All Hallows' Eve—later shortened to Halloween. [2] Over the centuries, the holiday evolved from a serious ritual into a more lighthearted celebration, though some of the old symbols—such as pumpkins and costumes—still remind us of its origins.

In the 19th and 20th centuries, Irish and Scottish immigrants brought Halloween to North America. There, it became a community event focused on children: costumes, parties, and trick-or-treating. Today, Halloween is celebrated in many countries, though customs vary. Some focus on family gatherings; others emphasize spooky decorations and horror-themed entertainment. [3] Wherever it is celebrated, Halloween offers a chance for creativity, play, and a break from everyday routine—a time when people can pretend to be someone or something else for a night.

Safety is important on Halloween. Children should go trick-or-treating in groups and only visit homes they know. Parents often check candy before children eat it. Costumes should be visible in the dark, and flashlights can help. [4] With a little planning and common sense, Halloween can be both fun and safe for everyone, letting families enjoy the holiday without worry.

Whether we see Halloween as a harvest celebration, a time for creativity, or simply a night of fun, it has become a beloved part of the calendar in many places. [5] As cultures continue to mix and traditions spread, Halloween will likely keep evolving, taking on new meanings and forms while keeping the spirit of imagination and community that has made it so popular around the world.

选项

A. Halloween has a long and fascinating history, and understanding where it came from helps us appreciate how traditions change and spread across cultures over time. B. Over the centuries, the holiday evolved from a serious ritual into a more lighthearted celebration, though some of the old symbols—such as pumpkins and costumes—still remind us of its origins. C. Wherever it is celebrated, Halloween offers a chance for creativity, play, and a break from everyday routine—a time when people can pretend to be someone or something else for a night. D. With a little planning and common sense, Halloween can be both fun and safe for everyone, letting families enjoy the holiday without worry. E. As cultures continue to mix and traditions spread, Halloween will likely keep evolving, taking on new meanings and forms while keeping the spirit of imagination and community that has made it so popular around the world. F. For example, in Mexico, the Day of the Dead (Día de los Muertos) on November 1st and 2nd celebrates and honors deceased family members with altars, flowers, and special foods.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍万圣节现代庆祝方式——化妆、南瓜灯、讨糖，并指出其源自古老节日，空后需概括理解历史的意义。A的"long and fascinating history"与"what began as an ancient festival"呼应，"understanding where it came from helps us appreciate how traditions change and spread"与空后历史演变段落自然衔接。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说萨温节起源、亡灵边界、篝火与伪装、与基督教结合成万圣节前夕，空后需总结节日从严肃到轻松的演变。B的"Over the centuries, the holiday evolved from a serious ritual into a more lighthearted celebration"与前文凯尔特仪式到基督教融合对应，"old symbols—such as pumpkins and costumes—still remind us of its origins"与"lit bonfires and wore disguises"呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说爱尔兰苏格兰移民将万圣节带到北美、发展为儿童社区活动、各国庆祝方式不同，空后需概括各地共同的节日价值。C的"Wherever it is celebrated"与"many countries, though customs vary"呼应，"creativity, play, and a break from everyday routine"与"costumes, parties, trick-or-treating"对应，"pretend to be someone or something else"与化妆主题衔接。
- **[4] D**：

- **线索**：空前列举安全提示——结伴、熟悉的人家、检查糖果、醒目服装、手电筒，空后需总结兼顾乐趣与安全。D的"With a little planning and common sense"承接前文安全措施，"Halloween can be both fun and safe for everyone"与前文各项建议形成总结，"letting families enjoy without worry"是合理延伸。

- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说不同人对万圣节有不同理解——丰收、创意、趣味，空后需展望节日未来。E的"As cultures continue to mix and traditions spread"与"changed and spread across cultures"呼应，"keep evolving, taking on new meanings and forms"与"beloved part of the calendar"衔接，"spirit of imagination and community"是全文收尾的合理升华。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, in Mexico, the Day of the Dead (Día de los Muertos) on November 1st and 2nd celebrates and honors deceased family members with altars, flowers, and special foods.**：以For example开头，为具体国家节日举例（亡灵节）。各空均为概括或过渡句；亡灵节与万圣节时间相近但为不同传统，[2]虽涉及历史演变，但需的是万圣节自身的演变概括，而非墨西哥亡灵节案例。